Original machine text

We study the detection of machine text. Our results show that formatting artifacts can be exploited by AI detectors.

Machine-generated
(machine formatting)

Formatting transform

Impose human or machine formatting while keeping the content identical.

Counterfactual *(F)*
→ human formatting

Placebo *(F_H)*
→ machine formatting

Formatted versions

Counterfactual (human-like)

We study the detection of↵
machine text.

␣␣Our results show that↵
formatting artifacts can be↵
exploited by AI detectors.

Placebo (machine-like)

We study the detection of
machine text. Our results
show that formatting artifacts
can be exploited by AI detectors.

Detector

Original (machine)

0.997 (machine)

Counterfactual

0.333 (human)

Placebo

0.991 (machine)